

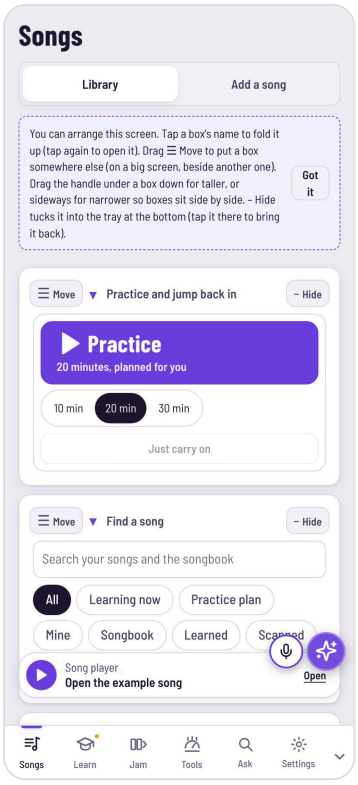
KGuitar

The manual

Quick Start (2 minutes), then every feature: why, when and how.

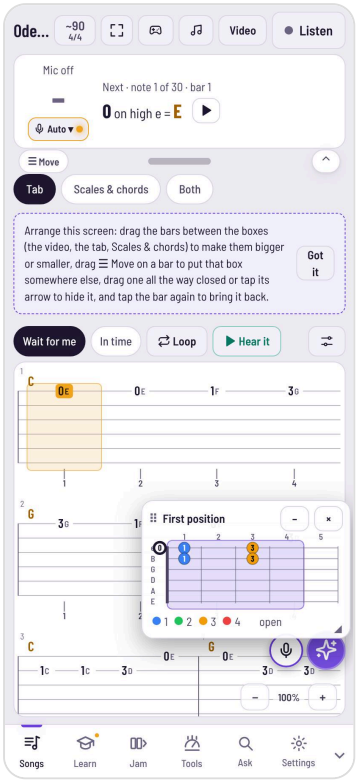
2026-11-12

Quick Start: 2 minutes



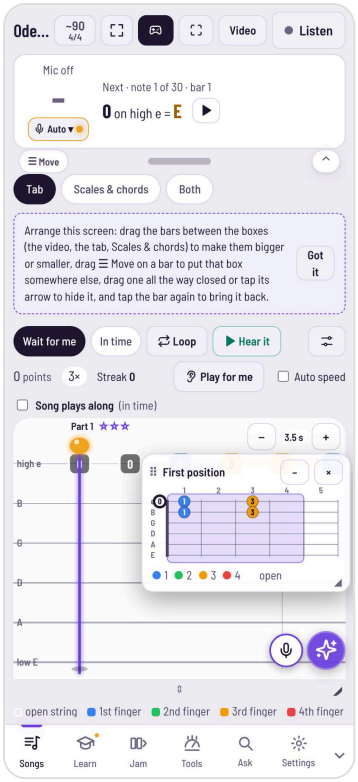
1 Pick a song

Tap **Songs**. The Library has everything you can play: your songs and the built-in songbook. "Learning now" is at the top. Tap any song.



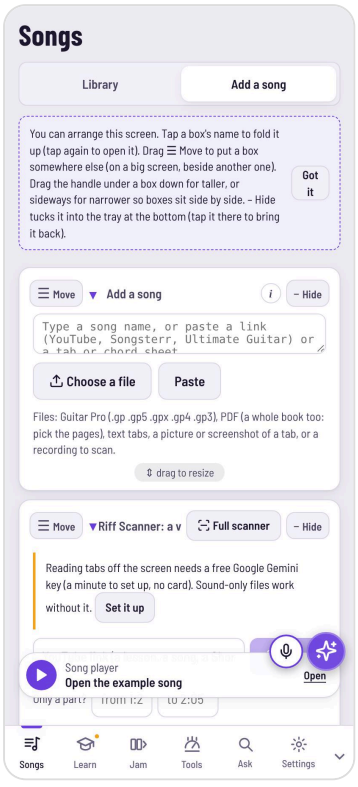
2 Play along

The song opens in the song player. Tap **Listen** (top right) and play: every right note turns green and the cursor moves on. **Wait for me** waits for you; **In time** keeps the beat. **Loop** repeats a hard part, **Hear it** plays it for you, **Options** has speed and more.



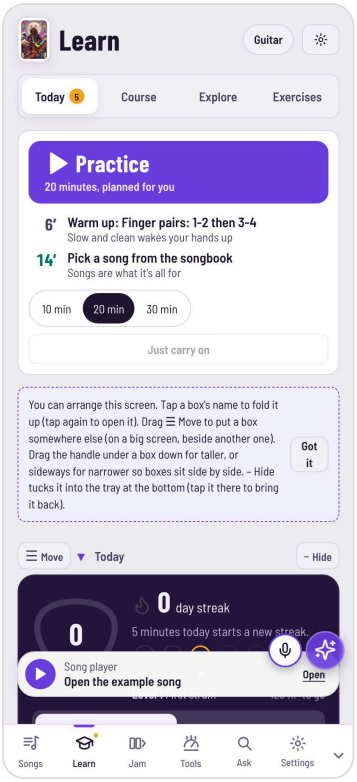
3 Game Mode

The game button turns the tab into a highway with a bouncing ball, like a game. Score stars, beat your best, slow it down until it's easy.



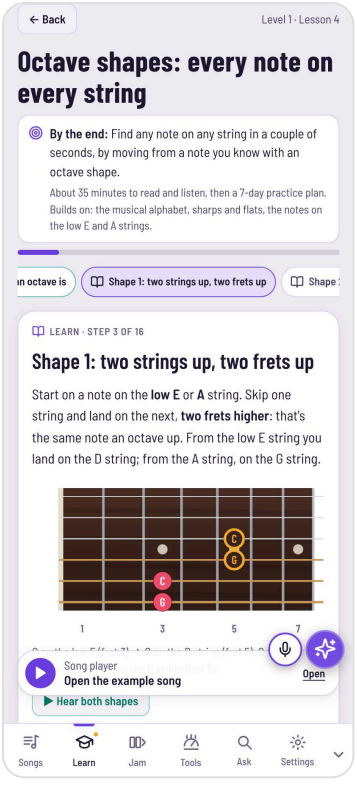
4 Add your own songs

Songs → **Add a song**: type a song name, paste a YouTube or tab link, paste a tab, or pick a Guitar Pro file, a PDF, a picture or a recording. One box does it all.



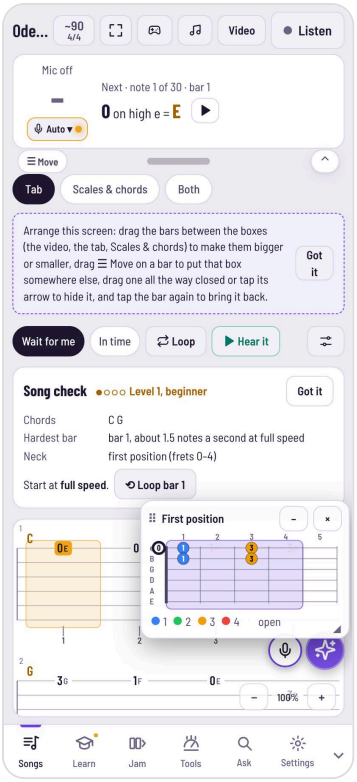
5 Practise every day

Tap **Learn**. Today shows a short plan made for you, your streak and your goal. Five minutes counts, with or without the guitar.



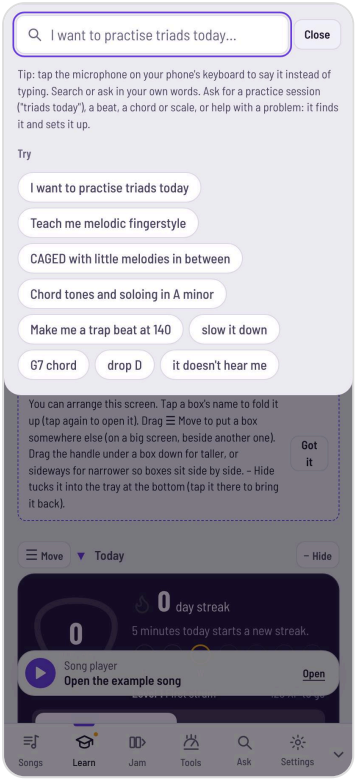
6 Learn the theory

Learn → Explore → **Theory lessons**: deep lessons step by step, with sounds, pictures of the neck, ear training, a practice week and checks.



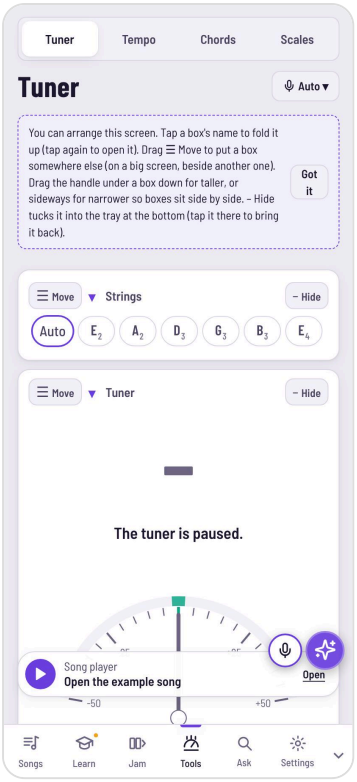
7 Jam with a band

Tap **Jam**: **Play with a band** (chord progressions with drums and bass), **Make a beat**, or **Loop myself** (a 4-track looper).



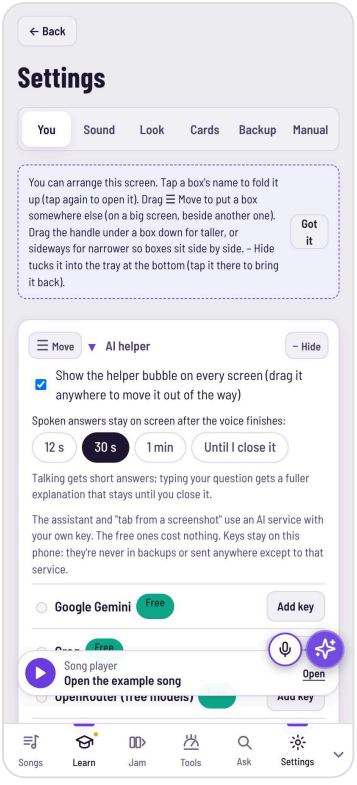
8 Ask anything

The ✨ bubble is your helper: ask how to do something, or a guitar question. A glowing dot means it has a tip for the screen you're on.



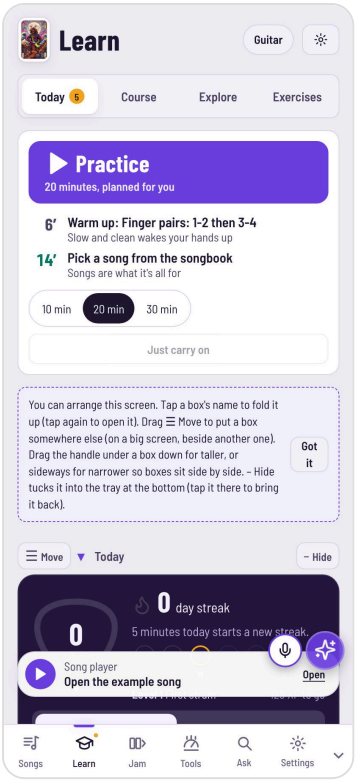
9 Tune up

Tap **Tools** for the tuner, metronome, chords and scales.



10 Make it yours

The **gear** opens Settings: your instrument, how you plug in (phone mic or USB), sounds, look and backup.



1. Start here

KGuitar listens while you play a tab and lights up every note you get right. Around that it teaches you, trains your ear and keeps you practising every day. It works for guitar and ukulele.

Why: Practice works best when every minute counts: the app hears what you play, so you get feedback a teacher would give, every day, without waiting for a lesson.

When: Start every session from Learn → Today (or the big Practice button in Songs) and let it plan the next 10–30 minutes.

Ask: search and the assistant in one

Tap Ask in the menu and type what you want in your own words. Short things ("G7", "drop D", "slow it down") open straight away. Bigger requests ("I want to practise triads today", "chord tones and soloing in A", "make me a trap beat at 140") make a practice session or set things up for you. It knows what's on your screen (the song, bar, loop, speed and chord in Play; the exercise, lick or Jam progression you have open), so you can ask "why is this bar hard?" or say "loop this bar slower" and tap the button it gives you. Spoken questions get short answers; typed questions get a fuller explanation (up to a few paragraphs) that stays until you close it. Answers from Gemini are read aloud in a natural Google voice you pick in Settings → You → AI helper (Gemini's voice); the built-in helper keeps the phone's own voice, so you can tell which one answered. If Google is busy it tries again, then a lighter Gemini model, then your other free key. It works without the internet; with a free AI key (Settings → You → AI helper) its answers get smarter and it can read pictures.

Practice sessions

A session is a few timed steps, like "4 min warm-up, 10 min triads, 8 min triads over a beat". Each step opens the right screen, already set up. A bar at the top shows the step and the time left: ⏸ pauses, Next moves on, tap the bar for the step list, a tip, +2 min or Stop. Save sessions you like: they wait in Learn → Today → My practice sessions.

Arrange your screens

Every screen is made of windows with a slim title bar: Tools (Tuner, Tempo, Chords, Scales), Songs, Learn, Jam, Settings and the Learn tools. Tap a window's name to fold it up. Drag ☰ to move a section somewhere else. Tap – to tuck it away: it waits as a button in the tray at the bottom, and one tap brings it back. Drag the ◢ handle under a section down to make it taller or shorter, or sideways to make it narrower or wider: widths snap to a third, a half, two thirds or full, so on the Fold's inner screen, a tablet or a computer narrow windows sit side by side (drag ☰ onto the left or right half of another window to put it beside that one). ⤢ puts a window back to its own size. On a narrow screen (the Fold's cover, a phone) windows are always full width. Learn's own pages keep one column for now. "Reset layout" in the tray puts everything back the way it was.

The menu

The bar at the bottom (or the side, on a big screen) has four sections plus Ask and Settings. Songs: your songs, the songbook, the exercise library (about 800 exercises) and adding a new song; tap a song and it opens in the song player (play along with the tab, the video, Game Mode). Learn: your daily plan, the course, lessons and progress. Jam: chord progressions with a band, soloing, making tabs and finding the chords of a song. Tools: tuner, metronome, chord library and scales. Ask: search and the helper. Settings (the gear): everything about how the app is set up, the floating cards for each screen, and this manual. While you are in the song player, Songs stays lit in the menu; on every other screen a Now playing bar at the bottom takes you back to your song in one tap. Most sections have a row of tabs across the top that splits them into a few short pages; each section remembers the page you were on, and tapping the section again in the menu takes you back to its start.

Tips

When there's a tip for the screen you're on, a gold dot glows on the ✨ bubble: tap ✨ to read it. Some tips point out a feature you haven't tried yet (Show me flashes the button), others are guitar advice: technique, timing and practice habits. Got it puts it away and the next one comes along a little later; No more tips here stops them on that screen; Ask about this asks the helper. If the mic hears the same bar go wrong a few times, a tip for that spot comes first. Settings → You → Tips: Glowing dot, Always show (the card opens by itself, never while you're playing), Only when I ask (the helper's "A tip for this screen" button), or Off, and a switch for the guitar advice.

Floating cards

Small cards that float over everything: Hand (where your fingers go), Chord now & next (with a beat countdown to the change), Mini neck (the key's notes around your hand with the chord's notes lit), What you played (what the mic heard against what the tab wants), Bar & beat, Tempo (change the speed right on the card), Quick tuner, Mini video (the song's YouTube video in a small player) and Practice timer. Pick them in the song player's Options or in Settings → Cards, a different set for each screen; show one or several. Drag a card's bar to move it, drag its corner to resize it, – shrinks it to a small bubble (tap the bubble to bring it back), × hides it. Cards always stay on top and place themselves where they cover the least; over the note you're on they fade a little but still take taps.

Search: just ask

Tap Search in the menu (or press / on a computer) and type what you want in your own words: "slow it down", "loop a hard part", "G7", "A minor pentatonic", "drop D", "metronome 90", "blues jam in A", "it doesn't hear me". Tap a result and it takes you straight there, already set up: the chord on screen, the tuner in that tuning, Play's Options open at the right setting (it flashes so you can see it). Typos are fine. If a song isn't in the app, it offers to look for its tab on Songsterr, Ultimate Guitar or Google.

The Back button

The phone's Back button closes whatever is open (Settings, a sheet, a picture, the menu), steps back a page (a lesson, a quiz), and from any section takes you back to where a link or a search took you from, then to Songs. On Songs with nothing open, press it twice to close KGuitar. On a computer the browser's Back button does the same.

Tune up first

Tools → Tuner. Play one string at a time; the needle and the note name show how far off you are. Turn the tuning peg until the note is green.

Set up your input (2 minutes)

So the app hears you properly. It measures your room, how loud your strings are and how much delay your headphones add. Do it once for the phone mic (acoustic) and once for a USB amp or audio interface (electric). Until you do, the input button in Play (🎤 Auto) has a small yellow dot.

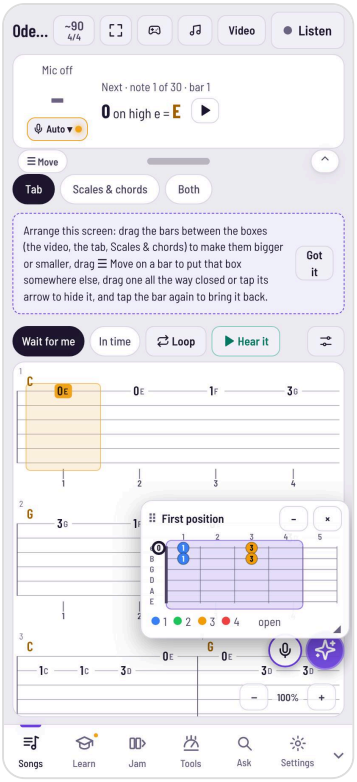
Settings is the gear in the menu: Sound → Set up input. Or in the song player: Options → Set up your input.

Tell it about you

The first time you open KGuitar it asks how long you've played and what you want to get better at (songs, strumming chords, fingerpicking, lead and solos, timing, knowing the neck) and which styles you like (folk, bluegrass, reggae). Your daily plan, the songs it suggests and how much help the tab shows follow your answers. Change them any time in Settings (the gear in the menu) → You → About you.

Guitar or ukulele

Settings (the gear in the menu) → You → Instrument. Pick guitar, tenor ukulele or baritone ukulele and the tuning. The whole app follows: chord shapes, tabs, tuner, quizzes. Songs are kept separately for each instrument, and the app asks "Are you sure?" before switching.



2. Play: playing along with tabs

The heart of the app. Load a tab, tap Listen, and play. Each right note turns green and the cursor moves on.

Why: Playing real music with instant feedback is the fastest way to get good: green notes show what's right, the loop and speed controls turn a hard bar into an easy one, and In time teaches you to stay with the beat.

When: Whenever you learn a song or a tab: Wait for me first (accuracy), then In time at a slower speed, then full speed with the band or the video.

Open a song

Tap Songs in the menu. It has two pages. Library: everything you can play in one place, your own songs and the songbook together. Learning now comes first (songs you've started, with reviews due on top), then Saved for later, Your songs and the Songbook. One search box finds any of them; the chips show one kind at a time (All, Learning now, Practice plan: reviews due, songs with a trouble spot and what you're learning; Mine, Songbook, Learned, Scanned: songs the Riff Scanner read from a video, picture or recording; Backing tracks: songs with a band or a video to play along with). With songs in different styles or tunings, a Style and a Tuning picker narrow the list. Add a song: one box for everything (see Add a song). Tap a song and it opens in the song player. The exercises and the tab maker are in Learn → Exercises.

Add a song

Songs → Add a song has one box. Type a song name and it searches Songsterr and Ultimate Guitar (straight in on the phone; on the web the site buttons open them). Paste a YouTube link and choose Find a tab (searched by the video's title, the video attached to the tab you pick), Scan it (the Riff Scanner works the tab out from the video) or Save for later. Paste a Songsterr or Ultimate Guitar page and it comes straight in (phone). Paste a tab or chord sheet, give it a title and tap Load tab. Choose a file: Guitar Pro, PDF (a whole book asks which pages), text, a picture or screenshot of a tab (the Riff Scanner reads it) or a recording (the Riff Scanner listens). Saved for later shows in Library with Find a tab.

Share straight into KGuitar

In a browser or tab site, select the tab text (or a whole chord sheet), tap Share, then KGuitar. Guitar Pro files from Drive or Downloads can be shared to KGuitar the same way ("Send a copy" in Drive). Sharing a YouTube link adds that video to the song you have open.

Listen: wait for me

Tap Listen and play. The app waits for each note, so go as slowly as you like. A wrong note shows what you played and what the tab wants. If you know you played it right and the app misheard you, tap "I played it right" (or a pedal set to it): it moves on, and from then on it counts that same sound as the right note on that input (phone mic and USB amp learn separately; Options → Learned shows how many and can forget them). The box at the top shows the next note and where it is. Under it, one row of controls: Wait for me / In time, Loop, Hear it, and Options (the sliders button) for everything else.

Chord sheets: strum along

Songs with chords written over the words (the most common way songs are shared) open as a strum-along: one chord per bar with its shape and the words underneath. Strum the chord and let it ring; the app checks all the notes of the chord. Try "Amazing Grace" in Learn → Exercises → Example songs.

In time: keep the beat

Switch "Wait for me" to "In time" and tap Start. A big 5-4-3-2-1 gives you time to get your hands on the guitar (change it in Settings → You → Get ready time), then a count-in bar shows a huge 4 3 2 1 over the tab, and the tab scrolls at tempo with a click; every note is marked on time, early or late, and you get a score at the end. Hear tab too plays the tab quietly along with you. When you play a song or loop cleanly in Wait for me, a note suggests the next step: Try In time, at ¾ speed.

Game Mode

Tap Game (top of Play) and the tab becomes a highway: notes slide toward the line, coloured by finger (open string, 1st to 4th finger), with the chord name above. Clean notes in a row raise the multiplier from 3× up to 5×; a miss drops it back. Each part of the song (verse, chorus, or every few bars) earns up to 3 stars, gold when every note was on time. At the end: points, stars per part and your best (the best run of each part, kept for every song). Perfect it loops the first part that lost stars, in time, with Auto speed (90% or better speeds up 5%, under 60% slows down 5%, from 25% to 125%). Play for me plays the next note or chord; tap any note on the highway to hear it. Full screen: with Game on, the Full screen button at the top shows only the game (the phone's bars hide too; swipe up to see them for a moment): the highway starts at a comfortable size and you make it any size you like with the corner handle (it scrolls if you make it bigger than the screen), floating cards like the hand diagram still float on top, and one bar at the bottom has Start (or Listen), Loop, Wait / In time, ⚙ for all the options (speed, sound, Song plays along and its slider) and ✕ to go back. Song plays along: tick it and the song plays while you play (In time), scored as you go: your part (the tab you are playing, played for you as a guide) and the band (the song's other instruments: a Guitar Pro file's drums, bass and other parts, or the songbook backing). The slider sets the mix: left for more of your part, right for more band, the middle (double tap) for both; a song with no other parts gets a volume for your part instead. Options → Hear the tab too has the same slider in the tab view. Look ahead: drag the highway sideways with one finger to see what is coming (or back to what you just played); let go and it glides back to now, or tap ⟲ Now. Zoom: pinch it, or tap − and + in its corner, to show more or fewer seconds of music (1.5 to 8 s; it remembers). Size: the highway fits its box, so drag the bar between the boxes to make it bigger; or drag the handle under it (◢ in its corner): down or up for taller or shorter strings, sideways for wider or narrower. It remembers your size; double tap the handle to fit the box again. Works in Wait for me and In time.

Play with the band

Options → Play with the band adds the rest of the band to Hear it, In time and Game Mode: a Guitar Pro file's drums, bass and other guitars, drums and bass made from the chords for songbook songs, or, for any chord sheet or tab with chord names, a chord band (drums and bass that follow the chords) in a style picked from the song (acoustic, bluegrass, country, pop, rock, reggae, blues, ballad, gospel or island; change it on the Mixer card, kept per song). Turn it off to hear just your part.

Mixer

Options → Mixer (or Mixer in Game Mode) opens a floating Mixer card: a slider for your part (the guide), the drums, the bass and the other parts, each with M (mute) and S (solo: hear only that), and the chord band's style. Double tap a slider for 100%. The levels are remembered; mute and solo are for now (Unmute everything puts them back). The your-part ↔ band slider moves the whole band together, and the Mixer sets each part inside it.

Count it: 1 & 2 &

Options → Count it: 1 & 2 & shows the rhythm under the tab: note stems, beams and the count for every note, so you can count out loud while you play. On a chord sheet, Options → Strum puts a strum pattern over each chord instead (arrows: down, up, B for a bass note and × for a chop, a quick muted strum), and In time checks each strum. Pick a pattern that suits the song, from plain downstrokes to reggae chops and waltz.

Chord help

When a strummed chord isn't right, the box under the next note says what's wrong: which note of the chord isn't ringing and which string to check, or which extra note rang out that doesn't belong.

Record yourself

Options → ● Record yourself records what the mic or amp hears while you play. A red timer button appears next to Hear it: tap it to stop, then listen back in the bar under the tab. Save keeps it as a file (share it to Drive or a friend); ✕ throws it away. Nothing is recorded unless you tap Record, apart from Then vs now (below), which you can switch off in Options.

Report card

After a whole run-through (Wait for me or In time) a card shows your score in a ring, how it compares with last time, and the bars that went wrong, marked with a dashed red box on the tab. One button does the most useful next thing: loop those bars (at 70% in In time), try it In time once Wait for me is clean, or speed up. ✕ closes it; starting again clears it.

Then vs now

Play quietly keeps two recordings of each song, on this phone only: your first whole run of it, and later your best run once it is at least 10 points better. When that happens the report card shows a Then vs now button: your first try and your best, side by side with their scores and dates. Tapping one stops the other, so you can flip between them. They are also in Learn → Explore → My recordings. Switch it off in Song player → Options → Then vs now.

Talk to the helper (hands-free)

Tap the microphone button beside the helper bubble and just say it: "slower", "loop bars 5 to 8 and slow the tempo", "full speed", "stop looping", "explain this hand position", "what does an augmented chord do?". Loop and speed changes happen straight away; the answer shows in a small card beside the bubble and is read out, so the tab stays in view. Tick Keep talking and it listens again after each answer, for a back-and-forth while you play (it stops after a few quiet tries). While you talk, Play doesn't count your voice as wrong notes. Uses the phone's speech recognition (needs the internet on most phones). With the USB amp plugged in, the phone may listen to the amp instead of you: unplug it, or use Chat. The spoken answer stays on screen for 30 seconds; Settings → You → AI helper changes that (12 s, 30 s, 1 min or until you close it).

Music stand

Tap Stand (the note button) at the top of Play for a view you can read from across the room: just the tab, much bigger, and one slim row of buttons at the very bottom: Listen / Start, Loop bar (loops the bar you're on; tap again to stop), − speed % +, back to the start, Big, and ✕ to leave (or the phone's Back). In the phone app the phone's own bar at the bottom (home, back, recent apps) hides while the stand is open: swipe up from the bottom edge to bring it back for a moment. Pinch the tab to set its music-stand size; it remembers it separately from the normal size.

Big view (the Fold closed)

On a narrow screen, like the Fold's cover screen, Stand opens the big view: the next note (fret and string) or chord, huge, the bar number, and the chord coming next. The box turns green when you get it and red when you don't, so you can see it from a few feet away. Underneath are big Listen, Loop, − speed +, and back-to-the-start buttons. Show the tab switches to the big tab; on the inner screen tap Big in the stand bar to get this view.

Tidy up while I play

On by default (Song player → Options). When you tap Listen or Start, the Scales & chords panel, the side panel and the menu fold away so the tab gets the room, with a small readout above it. A video that's showing stays. When you stop, everything comes back. Switch it off in Options if you'd rather keep your layout.

Peek at a chord shape

In Play, press and hold any chord name (above the tab, or in the Scales & chords strip). A big chord box pops up next to your finger: the shape the tab uses, or a common shape. It stays while you hold and goes away 1.5 seconds after you let go. Nothing stops: your loop, the tab and the listening keep going.

Loop a section + speed trainer

Tap ⟲ Loop, then the first and last bar of the hard part. The loop bars are shaded with bold lines at the start and end. It repeats and scores each pass, and "⟲ Again" flashes on the tab each time it goes round with your last score; the ✕ on the loop button stops looping. In In time mode, Options → Speed trainer starts slow and speeds up a little every time you score 90% or better.

Hear it

Plays the tab so you know how it should sound, with the cursor moving along. Options → Speed (½, ¾) slows it down, and Options → Sound switches between acoustic, J-45, nylon, clean electric, crunch and distorted. On Auto, a Guitar Pro file plays in its own guitar sound, and palm mutes (PM) and power chords play as real recorded palm mutes and power chords on the amp sounds.

Frets, notes or both

Options → Numbers: Frets shows the tab numbers, Notes shows the note names, Both shows each number with its note. Tap any number in the tab to hear it and start from there. Options → Size (A− / A+) changes the size of the tab, or pinch it with two fingers.

Rests

Long stretches with nothing to play (a part that comes in late, a long break) are squeezed into one short block that says how many bars to rest, so the tab starts where your part starts. Tap the block to start from there.

YouTube video beside the tab

Tap Video and paste a YouTube link. The video sits in a small folding panel: speed buttons slow it down, and A and B set a loop. Sync with tab lines the video up with the tab so, in In time mode, the tab scrolls with the recording. If a video says it can't play here, its owner blocks other apps: use Open in YouTube.

Sync by tapping

In Sync with tab, play the video and tap Tap along on every beat, starting on the first beat of the tab. After 8 taps the tempo and start point are set; keep tapping to make it more exact. Set it by hand is still there if you prefer.

Sync automatically

Video → Sync with tab → Sync automatically: go to a part of the video where the guitar plays the tab, tap it, and KGuitar listens to the video for 15 seconds and finds where the tab starts and its exact tempo (Android asks to allow recording the screen; only the sound is used and nothing is kept). If it isn't sure, it says so: tap along or set it by hand instead.

Scales & chords for soloing

The panel under the tab (or Scales & chords on small screens) shows the song's key, the scales that fit, the chords, and the fretboard. Arpeggio shows the chord's notes, Triads small chord shapes, Connect how to move smoothly to the next chord.

Split screen on a folding phone

Half-fold a Galaxy Fold like a little laptop and Play puts the video and readout on top and the tab on the bottom. Options → Split screen does the same on any phone or tablet.

Make the tab bigger

Drag the bars between the panels (the little grey handles) to give the tab more room, or drag a panel all the way to tuck it away; tap its arrow to bring it back. Drag ☰ Move on a bar to put that panel somewhere else: on the phone above or below the tab, on the big screen left or right (video and readout) and above or below (Scales & chords). Options → Move the panels → Put them back undoes it. The ⤢ button at the top (Full tab) hides everything but the tab and a slim note readout. Play remembers how you left it.

Where your fingers go

A small floating window shows where your fretting hand sits: the four frets it covers are shaded ("Index on fret 5"), and every note has the finger that plays it, in colour: 1 index blue, 2 middle green, 3 ring orange, 4 pinky red, open strings white. The note to play next is ringed. Two beats before your hand has to move, a gold "Upcoming shift" badge shows where to, with a dashed outline of the next position, the reason ("in the rest", "while the open B rings", "slide up with finger 3") and Loop this shift, which loops just those two bars. Drag the window by its top bar anywhere, make it bigger from its corner, tuck it into a chip with –. When it sits over the note you are on it fades so you can still tap the tab. Options → Where your fingers go turns it off and on.

Fingering engine

Every tab in KGuitar is fingered by one engine that plans your hand like a teacher: it looks ahead over the whole phrase, uses one finger per fret, measures stretches in real distance for your hand size (frets are wider near the nut), barres when one finger holds a fret, bends with the ring finger, keeps hammer-ons in one position, slides with the same finger, and moves your hand in rests, on long notes and while open strings ring. Tabs you load keep their frets: only the fingers are worked out. Settings → You → Your hand sets small, medium or large.

The 5-layer neck

Everything a chord shape holds, stacked under one hand. Pick a shape (C, A, G, E or D), then switch the layers on and off: Shape (the chord), Triads (three-note triads hiding inside it), Pentatonic (the five-note box around it), Mode notes (the two notes that turn the box into a full mode: pick Major, Lydian or Mixolydian, or Minor, Dorian or Phrygian) and Free fingers (violet rings: sus2, sus4, add9, 6th and 7th notes a spare finger can reach while you hold the chord; tap one to hear the chord and then that hammer-on). 3 per string shows the whole mode three notes per string from the shape's root. Double-stops shows two-note shapes around the chord: 3rds (Mayer, soul), 4ths (Hendrix) and 6ths (skip a string); tap one to hear it and see it on the neck. Drone holds a soft chord under you while you try things. Licks over (the chord) opens Must-know licks that fit it, shown in its key. The other buttons jump to the same chord in Chords or the CAGED explorer, or the mode in Scales. It is in the CAGED explorer (pick one shape), Song player → Scales & chords → Layers (the chord you are on, in the shape nearest your hand), Tools → Chords and Tools → Scales, and in the chord peek: hold a chord name, then Pin open.

Voice leading

Chord shapes chosen so your hand barely moves from one chord to the next. Gold rings are notes both chords share: keep that finger down. Gold arrows are the 3rds and 7ths (the notes that make a change sound like a change) sliding a fret or two; dashed arrows are other fingers. The line under the neck says it in words ("Hold G; B up a half step to C"). Pick where on the neck (low, middle, high) and 3 or 4 strings. Practise the changes opens the progression in Play as a tab, two bars per chord, four times round, and Wait for me listens for each chord. It is in Tools → Chords (from the chord you picked to its usual next chords), the CAGED explorer (common progressions in your key), Jam → Play with a band → Voice leading (your Jam progression, following the loop while it plays) and Song player → Scales & chords → Connect → Voice leading shapes.

Play the changes

Soloing that follows the chords: the neck shows the chord you are on in gold (root, 3rd, 5th, 7th and the 9th), the rest of the scale faintly, and two beats before the chord changes, the next chord's 3rd and root light up cyan with an arrow from the nearest gold note, so your line lands on the change. Song player → Scales & chords → Scale (Play the changes); it follows Hear it and In time. While the Jam band plays, the Mini neck card shows the scale to solo with and the Chord card counts down to each change.

Play it in your tuning, or without the capo

When a tab is in another tuning (Drop D, open G...), the notice above the tab offers Tune to it or Play it in your tuning: the same notes, moved to fit, with a line saying what changed ("6th string D→E: notes 2 frets lower"; notes lower than your lowest string go up an octave). As written puts it back. A tab with a capo can be played without it: Options → Capo → Without capo. Chord sheets get Smart capo in Options: the capo fret that turns barre chords into open shapes (a song in Eb with capo 1 is D G A Bm); it sounds the same.

Make it easier, and your own fingering

Song player → Options → Fingering → Easier for my hand plays the same notes on the strings and frets that are easiest for your hand and level (low on the neck, open strings welcome, few shifts). As written puts the tab back. Tap any note to see which finger plays it: tap 1, 2, 3 or 4 to choose your own, or Other string to play the same note somewhere else; the engine plans the rest around your choice, and it is saved with the song.

3. Exercises: the practice library

About 800 short exercises, like a teacher's workbook: every technique and a lot of theory, from your first warm-up to sweep picking. Learn → Exercises.

Why: Songs show you what you can't do yet; exercises fix it. Short, focused drills build one skill at a time, with the mic checking every note.

When: When a song keeps tripping you up in the same place (a stretch, a bend, a fast run), or for a 5-minute warm-up before songs.

Where your left hand goes

The floating Hand card shows where your fingers go for the note you're on: the four frets your hand covers ("Index on fret 5"), every note in its finger's colour (1 index, 2 middle, 3 ring, 4 pinky), and two beats before the hand has to move, where it goes next. It floats over the exercise like it does in the song player: drag it anywhere, – shrinks it to a bubble, × hides it (Settings → Cards brings it back). Generated tabs (Jam, the tab maker) still show the row of small hand necks underneath.

Find an exercise

Learn → Exercises opens with a row of sections: For you (today's picks, then every exercise), Technique, Fretboard, Chords & rhythm, Fingerstyle, Licks and Make your own (fingerpicking patterns, the lick chainer, the tab maker and the example songs). Inside a section, three menus filter the list: Difficulty (Beginner to Expert), Type (warm-ups, picking, legato, bends, scales, arpeggios, chord changes, strumming, fingerstyle, every style of lick ...) and Technique (alternate picking, hammer-ons, sweeps, palm muting ...). Type → Start here shows the essentials to learn first. "Exercise 12 of 787" says where you are; ‹ and › step through, the long menu jumps anywhere, 🎲 Random picks one, ↺ Clear resets the filters. Tap ☆ to keep an exercise in your favourites and tick Favourites only to see just those.

Hear it, then play it

Pick a Key (exercises that move use any key they fit; open-string ones use a capo), a Guitar sound and a Tempo. ▶ Play plays it with a one-bar Count-in, a Metronome click and, if you like, a Loop. The card shows the chord, the neck with every note numbered in the order you play it (roots in red; chords show their shape), and the tab with the counts under it. Tap any note in the tab to hear it and start from there, or drag the slider.

Play along: it listens

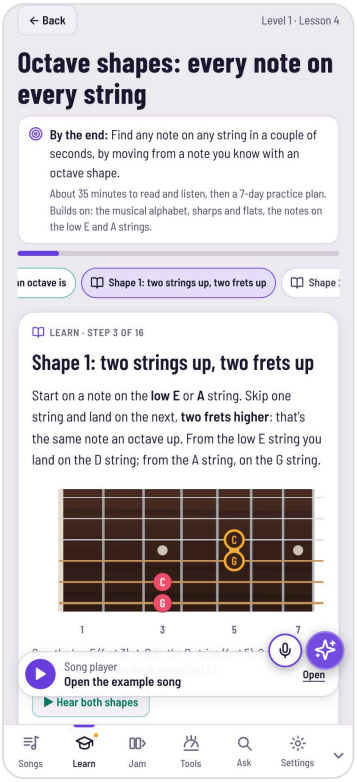
Play along (it listens) opens the exercise in Play at your tempo: Wait for me checks every note, In time scores your timing, and the speed trainer can take it faster each time. Licks with a breakdown also have a "How to play it, step by step" button.

Melodic fingerstyle

Type → Melodic fingerstyle: the beautiful, peaceful acoustic sound. Open-string chords (Cadd9, Em7, D/F#, add9s and maj7s) picked p-i-m-a, hammer-ons that make a sus chord bloom into a major one, harmonic bells, cascading scales where every note rings into the next like a harp, a Spanish melody, a chord melody, and progressions like the Canon. Learn → Technique has a lesson on it, the lick library has its phrases explained, and Jam has it as a style.

Chord tones through the changes

Type → Chord tones through the changes teaches you to solo with the chords, not just the scale: arpeggios on every chord, moving to the nearest note of each new chord, guide tones (the 3rds and 7ths) and landing on the 3rd right as the chord changes, over a ii–V–I, a 12-bar blues and more.



4. Learn: your daily practice

Open Learn every day. It shows what to practise, keeps your streak and tracks everything.

Why: Little and often beats long and rare. Learn keeps the habit going (streak, plan, reminders), teaches the theory that makes everything make sense, and brings back what you're about to forget.

When: Every day, first thing: the Today plan; the theory course a lesson a few days at a time; quizzes on days away from the guitar.

Zero to Hero (guitar)

Learn → Course follows your Zero to Hero plan: five phases, each ending in a gate (a short skill check) before the next. Tick what you can already do and it starts you at the right week. "Today's routine" runs the five daily blocks (warm-up, chords and rhythm, your current skill, fretboard and ear, songs) as a session in 20, 45 or 60 minutes; Saturday is song day. Gate items the app can measure tick themselves; tap "I can do it" for the rest. Each phase links to the free JustinGuitar lessons that go with it.

Style paths

Learn → Course → Zero to Hero → Style paths: go deep on one style next to the main plan (bluegrass flatpicking, acoustic songwriting, reggae rock, blues-rock, pop and soul, melodic prog and metal, Hawaiian slack key, classical guitar, fingerstyle). Tap Follow and that path's next step joins today's routine. Each step opens the right licks, exercises, songbook songs or Jam style; tap ✓ when you've got it. Everything in a path is also open on its own any time.

Lesson videos in Zero to Hero

Most steps in Zero to Hero and the style paths have a ▶ Watch button: a YouTube lesson for exactly that skill, from the best teacher for it (the style paths use players of that style: Tyler Grant and Molly Tuttle for flatpicking, Cory Wong for funk, Marco Cirillo for fingerstyle, Jeff Peterson for slack key ...). It plays right there and is ticked ✓ Watched once you play it. Every other day, Today's routine adds one video you haven't watched yet.

Hawaiian slack key

Learn → Explore → Technique has four slack key lessons: open G (taro patch: D G D G B D), the alternating thumb with the melody on top, hammer-ons, pull-offs and sweet 6ths, and harmonics with the Hawaiian vamp. Each has a video from a slack key teacher and a drill that listens to you (the open G thumb drill, Kona Morning, Trade Wind Vamp). The Tuner has Open G and C wahine; Jam has a Hawaiian slack key style, Make a tab writes slack key phrases in open G, and the Songbook has Hawaiian & slack key pieces.

Practice: one button

At the top of Learn → Today and Songs → Library. Tap Practice and the app plans it for you, and shows the plan underneath: a warm-up at your level, what your Zero to Hero plan is on now, the bars that go wrong most in a song you've played lately (looped at 70% speed), then a song: one that's due for a review, the one you were on, or one from the songbook. Pick 10, 20 or 30 minutes. It runs as a session: the bar at the top counts each step down and moves you on. Just carry on goes straight back to your last song, same bar, loop and speed.

Lick chainer

Learn → Explore → Lick chainer (also in Learn → Exercises, and "＋ Add to my lick chain" on every must-know lick). Tap licks to line them up like train cars, drag ⠿ or use ‹ › to reorder, ×2 to repeat one. They all move to one key and each sits near where the last ended on the neck. "Add one that flows" picks a lick that starts close to where your chain ends. Pick the key, tempo and the space between licks, hear it, then Play along and it listens.

Suggested exercises

Learn → Exercises opens with three picks for today: a warm-up, what your plan is working on, and one at your level or a step further. Tap one to load it in "Play it". All the others are still below.

My recordings

After you record yourself in Play (Options → Record yourself), tap "Keep it" and the take goes into Learn → Explore → My recordings, grouped by month. "Then vs now" at the top shows the first try and best run Play kept for each song, and pairs your own takes of the same song too, so you can hear how far you've come. Add a note to any take, save a copy to the phone, or delete one (it asks first).

Today, Course and Explore

Learn has three pages. Today: the today card, your plan for today and the daily quests. Course: the practice course quizzes and the path to mastery. Explore: every Learn tool in three groups (Play better, Ears and theory, You). The number on Today is how many plan steps are left.

Today card

The pick fills up as you practise toward your daily goal and turns into a green check when you reach it. Any 5 minutes keeps your streak alive. Every 7 days in a row earns a streak freeze that saves a missed day.

I'm away from my guitar

Tap it when you don't have your instrument (work, travel). The plan and quests switch to things you can do without it (lessons, tap quizzes, ear training with headphones) and it still counts. It switches itself off after 30 hours.

Today's plan

A short session made for you: tune up, warm up, a quiz, a song (or the bars you keep missing, or a song due for review), and one more skill. It follows your level and goals (About you): a beginner gets chord changes and an easy songbook part, someone who likes bluegrass gets bluegrass songs. Tap a step to go straight there; it ticks itself off.

Daily quests and levels

Three small challenges a day for extra XP. XP comes from practice time and right answers; levels and badges come with it.

Practice course

Learn → Course: tap Continue for your next quiz, or open a topic to pick one. Quizzes on fretboard notes, chords, triads, the circle of fifths and CAGED. Answer by tapping, or switch to Play and answer on your instrument (the mic checks it). What you miss comes back more often until it sticks. Up to three stars per quiz.

Path to mastery

Learn → Course, under the quizzes: seven stages from first steps to mastery, each with goals that tick off on their own as you hit them. Tap a goal to work on it.

Ear training

A soft drone plays the home note of a key; then a note plays and you name it by how it feels against home. After each answer it walks back home. Levels unlock as you go. Turn on "Use my guitar" to answer by playing the note.

The new theory course (sample lesson)

Learn → Explore → Theory lessons shows a dashed card at the top: a sample lesson of the new 8-level theory course (Octave shapes: every note on every string). Each deep lesson is a set of steps you move through with Next (the step list is a strip on the phone and a column on big screens): Why it matters, several short Learn steps with sounds and neck pictures you can tap, Worked examples (try it, then Show me how), Hear it (ear drills for exactly that idea), Common mistakes, a 7-day Practice week (tabs open in Play and the mic follows you; tick each day Done), Use it in music, Check (Apply, Hear and Play quizzes tick themselves when you pass, plus Explain it back, where the helper asks you to explain it like a teacher would) and Go deeper (a video and the pages of your own books). Finish the lesson and it comes back as a 5-minute review at the top of Today after 1, 3, 7 and 30 days.

My books

Learn → Explore → My books: your own guitar books on this phone. Import the book pack file you were sent (it stays on the phone only), and optionally add the PDFs (pick them all at once; each is matched to its book). Search every page of every book, open a book at its contents, read a page as text or (with the PDF) as the real page, Read this page's tab into Play (opens the PDF at that page in Add a song), or Ask the teacher about this page. "In your books" lists the matching pages next to lessons, the CAGED explorer, techniques and the Scales tool, and the helper uses your books when it teaches you (it says which book and page).

Theory lessons: read, watch, play

On guitar the lessons start with Guitar theory: the essentials, 12 short lessons in the order of No Bull Music Theory for Guitarists (the musical alphabet, tones and semitones, the major scale, triads, intervals, keys, building the chords of a key, progressions, pentatonics, natural minor, minor keys); each ends with something to play and a quiz in the Guitar theory unit of Practice, and names the chapter of the book to read next. After them come short lessons from the basics to harmony, plus CAGED and how to practise. Each has three steps: 1 Read (with sounds to tap), 2 Watch (a YouTube video that explains the same idea on the guitar; it plays right in the lesson, or Open in YouTube), 3 Play (exercises with tabs that open in Play and listen to you). On ukulele, lessons switch to a ukulele teacher where there is a good one (and a baritone teacher on baritone; otherwise the guitar video, since a baritone is tuned like the guitar's top four strings). Each lesson links to the full chapter on Offtonic Theory.

Technique

Learn → Explore → Technique: holding the pick, clean fretting, first chords, strumming, alternate picking, muting, palm muting, hammer-ons and pull-offs, slides, bends, barre chords and Travis picking. Each has what to aim for, a lesson video, and a drill tab that listens to you. Skills you have practised are ticked.

Must-know licks

Learn → Explore → Must-know licks: the licks every player of a style should know, in 16 styles, each with a breakdown: what it is, how to play it step by step, the secret to making it sound right, where to use it and a tempo to aim for. Pick a key (open-string styles use a capo), hear it at full or slow speed, then Play along and the app listens.

Your video lessons (phone app)

Learn → Explore → Your video lessons plays course videos you have on the phone. Copy the course folder onto the phone (USB cable, or download it from Google Drive), tap Find my lessons and choose the folder. The lessons show chapter by chapter with a Continue button; each video has speeds from ¼× to 1¼×, ±5 seconds, an A–B loop, Mirror (flips the picture so the teacher's hands match yours), resume and a Done tick. A chapter's Guitar Pro or text tabs open in Play with the video beside them (sync it with the tab like a YouTube video); PDFs open in your PDF app. Nothing is copied or uploaded, and it isn't in the web version.

Bends & vibrato

Pick a string, a fret and how far to bend (½ step, whole step or 1½ steps), bend and watch the needle: it turns green when the bend reaches the right pitch and holds there. Vibrato mode shows how wide and how fast your wobble is, and a trace draws your pitch over time.

CAGED explorer

Any chord in five shapes up the whole neck, with the arpeggio, pentatonic, scale and triads inside each shape.

Circle of fifths

Tap a key to see its chords and key signature and hear how they sound. Every key on the circle shows how many sharps or flats it has (2♯, 3♭ …), so you can read key signatures at a glance. The same circle is in Jam → Play with a band (Circle of fifths, in the tray).

One-minute chord changes

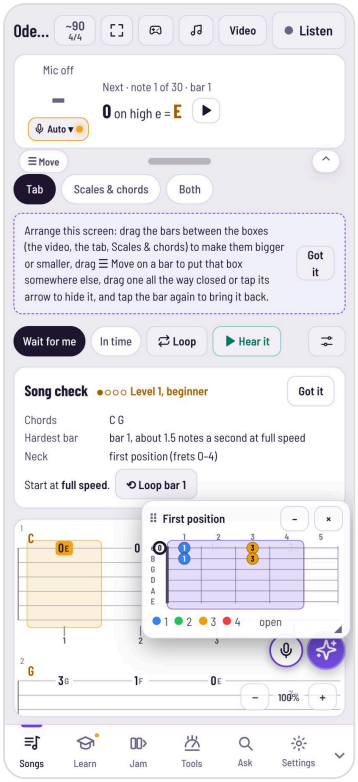
Switch between two chords as many times as you can in a minute. Tap for each clean change, or let it listen and count for you. Do it daily and watch the number climb.

Rhythm trainer

Listen to a bar, then a bar of clicks counts you in (1, 2, 3, 4), then tap it back (or strum it) against the click. Nine levels from quarter notes to swing. Each tap gives a little buzz (Buzz) and, if you like, a tiny tap sound (Tap sound).

Progress

Your practice calendar, this week compared with last, badges and how well you know each part of the course. Skill trends show small graphs of your chord changes a minute, how on time you are in In time, your rhythm trainer scores and the speed you play each song cleanly, so you can see yourself getting better.



5. Jam: progressions and looping

Make chord progressions to play over, with strumming and drums, and record yourself as a loop.

Why: Playing over a band is where theory turns into music: you hear how scales sound over chords, practise timing with a groove and build your own ideas.

When: After learning a scale or a lick, to use it for real; to write your own progressions and songs; to loop yourself and solo over it.

Beat maker

Jam → Make a beat. Drum on the pads with several fingers at once: kick, snare and hi-hat are the three big ones, and hitting nearer the top of a pad is louder. Pick a style under "Start from", or build it yourself. Pads Small/Medium/Big changes their size.

Sample mode: record onto a pad

Beat maker → Pads → Sample (or Your pads): hold a pad and make a sound (your voice, a guitar hit, a knock on the body); let go and it's on the pad, trimmed. A quick tap opens the pad's settings: pitch, volume, play backwards, one shot / only while held / loops while held, fades, and a choke group (a pad that cuts off the others, like a hi-hat). Pads can also play an instrument note or a whole chord, or a file from your phone. Your pads has 32 of your own, in Bank A (1–16) and Bank B (17–32); a dot shows a bank that has sounds on it.

Get a sound (films, songs, YouTube)

Beat maker → Your pads → Get a sound: pick an audio or video file, or play a YouTube video and tap Record what plays (up to 75 seconds; only the sound is kept). Drag the edges to pick the bit you want ("Luke, I am your father"), Hear it, Trim the quiet, then Put it on a pad. Voice only, Without the voice, Drums, Bass or Instruments pull that part out of the sound on the phone (a one-time download of the separation model, kept on the phone). Chop cuts it onto several pads: at each hit, in equal pieces, or where you tap.

Pitch dial

Tap a pad of yours, then turn the Pitch dial: up to two octaves higher or lower, anything in between (squeaky chipmunk to giant). Tape changes the speed with the pitch, like a record; Keep the speed keeps it in time. Keep a voice natural stops a shifted voice sounding like a cartoon.

Fit to the beat

In a recorded pad's settings, Fit to the beat shows the sample's own tempo and key. Stretch to the beat's tempo (same pitch) and Move it to the beat's key (same speed) make a loop or a riff line up with your beat. In the Looper, a loop played at its own speed offers to change the beat to its tempo.

Mic effect

Next to Sample, Chop a riff and the Looper: Mic effect puts an effect on what you record (More bass, More treble, Fuzz, Robot, Reverb, Octave up, Octave down or Synth). It goes onto the recording; your live guitar is never changed.

Chop a riff onto pads, and Keys mode

Chop records a riff and cuts it at every note you pick: the notes land on Your pads, one per pad, to play in any order. In the Keyboard, Sound → Your pads plays one recorded pad up and down the keys (it finds the note you recorded).

Effects pad

Effects: pick Filter, Echo, Reverb, Stutter, Crush or Gate and drag a finger round the square to play with the whole beat (the labels say what left–right and up–down do). Let go and it goes back to normal.

Parts A–D and song mode

The beat has four parts (A, B, C, D): make a new one empty or as a copy, and the pads, steps and loops play the part you're on. Song chains the parts in the order you set (A A B A ...) so the beat plays as a whole song.

Bounce and save

Bounce turns the whole beat into one loop, or Resample onto a pad puts it on one of Your pads to play and chop again, so you can build on it; Undo brings the parts back. Save as WAV makes a sound file of the beat (and, if you like, one file per part: drums, keys, loops) to share.

Undo and redo

↶ and ↷ in the beat maker step back and forward through your changes (Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Shift+Z on a keyboard).

Build a beat loop by loop

In Drum layers, tap a pattern ("Hi-hat 8ths", "Off-beat hi-hat", "Four-on-the-floor kick", "Snare on 2 and 4"...) to add it as a layer: no tapping a hi-hat 64 times. Or press ● and play the pads: each time round the loop becomes its own layer, snapped to the beat, so your timing doesn't have to be perfect. Mute (M), remove (✕) or undo the last layer any time.

Keys and chords

The Keyboard plays pianos, organs, strings, choirs, synths and more. "Chords" plays a whole chord from one key (pick major, minor, 7, 9, dim and more, or hold a type with one hand while playing with the other); "Chords in (key)" plays the right chord for the song's key. Every note of the chord lights up, and the neck below shows the same chord on guitar. Press ● and what you play goes into the piano roll.

Loops that line up with the beat

Beat maker → Looper: the strip with ▶, the part (A or B) and the 4 looper tracks. Tap a number to record on that track: it starts on the next bar line and plays in time with the beat. Open the 4-track looper for lengths, overdubs and the mix. Foot pedal: right = record / overdub, left = undo, hold right = stop.

Practise over your beat

Tap "Practise over it" in the tray: the neck shows a scale in the beat's key, and the notes of the chord playing now light up gold. Pick a lick to try over it; its hand positions show underneath.

Riff Scanner

The Riff Scanner (Songs → Add a song, or the Riff Scanner link under Jam's three buttons) gets a riff, a solo or a whole song into KGuitar. Three big buttons: Scan a video, Shorts and Listen. Scan a video: paste a YouTube link (and From / To for just a part) and tap Scan. First Gemini watches the video itself and writes down the tab (read off the screen when one is shown), the tempo, time signature and chords. If it can't (a private video, no key, its daily limit), KGuitar plays the video here and grabs its own screen and the sound inside the phone (Android asks to allow screen capture each time; the mic isn't used). If the video won't play inside other apps, it shows how to make a screen recording with Media sounds and pick it. Play it out loud (the mic) is the last resort. Or add screenshots of a tab shown in a video (a few, in order, if it scrolls) or pick a video or audio file (a Samsung screen recording of a lesson works). KGuitar finds the tab on screen and shows it in a box (drag the box or its corners if it missed some), enlarges and sharpens it, follows a scrolling tab and stitches it together, then the AI reads it (Gemini and Groq race; the first good answer wins). The steps show as they happen, with Cancel. The tempo comes from the sound. Anything worked out only from the sound asks "Does this look right?" first. Then: Open in Play, Practise it today (it becomes the song in your Practice button), Use the chords in Jam, or Fix the tab text. Reading tabs needs the free Google Gemini key. Songs → Add a song has the picture part too (and reads scanned PDFs).

Shorts

Riff Scanner → Shorts (the link under Jam's three buttons): a feed of short guitar videos in the styles you like (melodic prog, acoustic songwriter, blues and jazz, bluegrass, slack key), mixed so no channel takes over, plus new Shorts from the channels you Follow. Swipe or tap Next; Scan this Short turns the riff into a tab. It needs your own free YouTube key (Key and channels, or Settings → You); the key stays on this phone. Without a key it still shows the channels you follow. You start out following Mr. Tabs, Level Up Guitar Tabs and Kenneth Acoustic (KGuitar finds them by name; remove any with ✕ and it stays removed). Find channels for me searches new Shorts in your styles, checks a few frames of each channel for a tab on screen and lists the channels that really post tabs, with a Follow button.

Make a progression

Jam has three big buttons: Play with a band (chord progressions with a backing band), Make a beat (the beat maker) and Loop myself (the 4-track looper); under them a small link opens the Riff Scanner. On Play with a band, tap New progression. Every chord shows its shape; lock the ones you like (the padlock) and tap New progression again to change the rest. Options (top right) sets the key, style, how many chords, chord colours, endings and how adventurous it gets. Famous progressions are at the bottom. Loop over it turns the progression into a beat and opens the 4-track looper on it. Voice leading, the Circle of fifths and Make a tab from these chords wait in the tray (tap one to bring it out)

Play along

Tap Play loop for guitar, bass, drums and a click. The drums play a fill at the end of each pass and a crash when it comes round again. Solo over it: while the band plays, two floating cards come up: Chord now & next (with a countdown to each change) and the Mini neck (the best scale to solo with over this progression around your hand, the chord's notes lit, its root in red). Move them, shrink them to a bubble or hide them; Settings → Cards picks which cards show over Jam. They rest when the band stops

Guitar sound, bass and drums

Each style picks its own sound: metal gets the distorted amp with palm mutes and power chords, rock and blues get crunch, funk, reggae and country get clean electric, folk and slack key get the J-45 acoustic, jazz a warm jazz guitar, classical nylon. Tap the Band line under Play loop to change the guitar sound, strum, drums or bass any time. On the amp sounds the backing guitar is double-tracked (two takes, left and right), like a real rhythm part. The drums are a real recorded kit (double kick for metal, one drop, rockers and steppers for reggae with the cross-stick), and the bass follows the chords: walking for jazz, root–fifth for country, eighths for rock.

4-track looper

Jam → Loop myself: four tracks on the beat (1 Rhythm, 2 Embellishments, 3 Bass, 4 Lead). Tap a track's big round button: ARMED, then it records from beat 1 of the next bar. Pick a length first (1 bar up to 8 times the beat) and it closes by itself, or leave it on Auto and tap again where the loop should end. Tap a playing track to overdub, tap again to stop adding. Each track has a waveform, a ring going round with it, volume, pan (L–R), M (mute), S (solo), Undo, Redo and Clear; More has Backwards, Half speed, the bass octave (track 3 plays an octave lower, so your guitar sounds like a bass) and Others dip (the lead stands out). Part A / B switches the beat and all four loops on the next bar (verse and chorus). Start with Free and your first loop sets the tempo. The neck underneath shows each bar's chord notes. Resample and save: the whole mix onto a pad, onto an empty track, or into My recordings. A loop can be chopped onto pads or turned into a tab (More). Footswitch: A record / overdub, B stop (hold: clear), C undo (hold: redo), D part A / B (hold: stutter). If loops sound late, run the Timing check in its Settings.

Make a tab

Learn → Exercises → Make your own has the tab maker in four parts: Fingerpicking (your chords as Travis picking, arpeggios, slack key, a melodic fingerstyle roll, percussive slaps, classical triplets and more), Licks & solos, Chord melody and Riffs. It uses your Jam progression (Jam → Play with a band → Make a tab from these chords opens it), or a style's own chords in any key. Pick a style, a length and a level. Every tap writes a new one over your chords: an idea, its answer and an ending that lands home, with the style's own techniques (bends, slides, legato, taps, harmonics, double stops, ghost notes). Preview plays it; Open in Play follows you note by note.

Chord melody

Writes a singable tune over your chords with the chords under it, arranged the way the style does it: slack key and Travis keep the thumb going, classical ripples the inner notes, melodic fingerstyle lets open strings ring, country goes boom-chick, jazz and neo-soul put 3rds and 7ths under the tune, Hawaiian doubles it in 6ths. Melody only and Melody + bass are easier versions; tap again for a new one.

Licks, solos and riffs: the styles

21 styles, each built from how the players you like really play (each style lists players to listen to): melodic prog, prog-pop (tapping and hybrid picking), shred and melodic rock, prog metal, heavy metal, blues-pop, classic rock, blues, pop and soul, neo-soul, funk, jazz, modern country, bluegrass, modern flatpicking, acoustic singer-songwriter, reggae rock, Hawaiian slack key in open G, Hawaiian, melodic fingerstyle and classical. Only bluegrass stays near the headstock (with a capo, like the pickers); the others use the neck the way those players do. Riffs: djent and gallops, power chords, funk 16ths, reggae skanks and dub lines.

Find the chords from a song

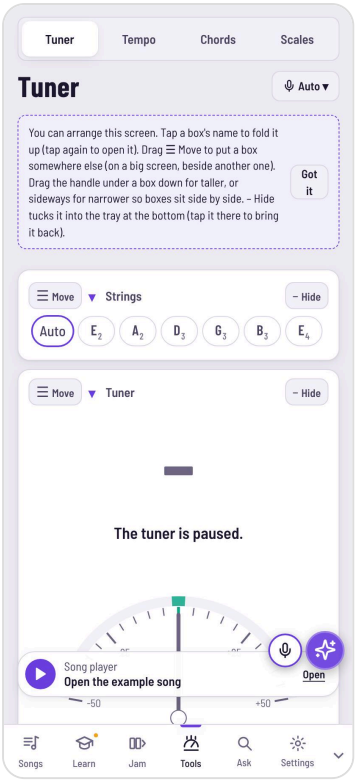
Riff Scanner (the link under Jam's three buttons) → Listen. Play a song out loud near the phone (a YouTube video on the speaker, a record) and tap Listen: KGuitar listens through the mic and writes down the chords and the key (a guess you can check). Chords mode is for strummed songs; Notes is a quick rough guess at a single-note line. It tells playing from talking and singing: talking is always left out, and singing is left out unless you turn on Include singing. Tap a chord to change it, then Use in Jam to jam over it, or open it in Play. Pulling every note out of a full band mix isn't reliable yet (for anyone): for exact notes use Notes from a recording below, or bring the real tab in from Songsterr.

Notes from a recording (accurate)

Riff Scanner → Listen → Notes from a recording: Record yourself playing (or a solo guitar lesson on the speaker), or pick an audio or video file. A note detector made for this (Basic Pitch, by Spotify) writes down every note right on the phone, even chords. Choose Single notes or With chords, fix the tempo if the rhythm looks off, and Open as a tab. Works best with one instrument at a time; for a lesson with talking or a song with singing, tick Take the voice out first (the voice model takes it out before the notes are written down).

Backing guitar

Turn off Backing guitar to keep just the bass and drums while you play the chords yourself (on the Hear row: Backing guitar, Bass, Drums, Click). The app never plays your own guitar back: what you play through the amp stays in your amp.



6. Tools

Everyday helpers.

Why: The everyday basics, always one tap away: an accurate tuner, a metronome, chord and scale finders.

When: Before every session (tune up), whenever you practise with a click, and when you need a chord shape or scale on the spot.

Tuner

Open it and it starts listening straight away: no Start button. Pluck one string and let it ring. The big needle and the cents number (to a tenth of a cent) show how far off you are, the frequency is underneath, and the advice says which way to turn. The string it hears lights up; tap a string to tune just that one, or leave it on Auto. The reading holds steady while the note rings, so you can turn the peg slowly. Standard and alternate tunings, plus reference tones to tune by ear. Pick a tuning other than Standard and "What this tuning changes" says it in plain words: which strings move, what that does to the shapes you know, and what an open tuning gives you (one finger across = a chord, the drone strings).

Tempo (metronome)

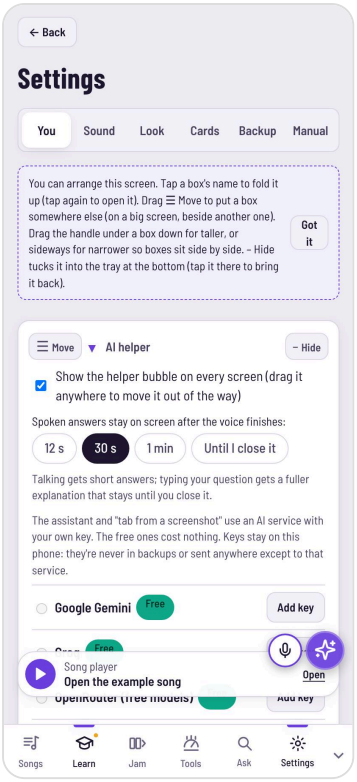
Accents, subdivisions, odd time signatures, tap tempo and a speed trainer. Sounds include a real cross-stick, cowbell and hi-hat, and Drum beat swaps the click for a recorded drummer (rock, metal, reggae, swing ...) at any tempo, with a fill every 8 bars.

Chords

Every common chord in every key, with several shapes. Tap a shape to hear it. Under the shapes: ▶ The chord, ▶ As an arpeggio and ▶ Its scale let you hear it three ways, Scales that fit lists the scales to solo with (▶ to hear, On the neck to see them), and Licks that sound good over it gives licks in many styles placed on this chord, to hear, learn or play along with.

Scales

22 scales and modes on the whole neck or one position at a time.



7. Your gear

KGuitar works with the phone mic for acoustic instruments and with a USB amp or audio interface for electric.

Why: Good input = accurate feedback. Setting up your mic, USB pedal or interface once makes note detection and timing reliable.

When: The first time you play, when you change how you plug in (phone mic, Pocket Master, interface), or if notes are being missed.

Acoustic: the phone mic

Hold or prop the phone 30–50 cm from the soundhole. Quiet rooms work best. Use headphones for videos and backing so the mic hears only you.

Electric: USB amp or interface

Plug a USB multi-effects pedal, headphone amp or audio interface (for example the Sonicake Pocket Master) into the phone's or tablet's USB-C port. Automatic input picks it up when it's plugged in. Use a clean or lightly driven sound while learning; heavy effects make notes harder to tell apart.

Pedal + wireless (mono)

With the Pocket Master plugged in, KGuitar goes mono by itself so the wireless (left side only) hears everything, and never plays your guitar back (the pedal does). Wired headphones? Tap "Switch to stereo" (notice, input list, or the Mono chip in the beat maker). Run "Check the timing" once with the wireless on. If it shows as "USB audio", tap "Yes, that's my pedal".

Hands-free with a footswitch

Pair a Bluetooth page-turner or footswitch: right pedal starts and stops, left pedal goes back to the start. Settings → Sound → Hands-free lets you set what each pedal does (loop this bar, next bar, Hear it, video ...). A MIDI pedal like the Chocolate Plus: tick "Use a MIDI pedal", switch the pedal to Bluetooth MIDI and tap "Find my Bluetooth pedal" (it reconnects by itself after that; USB MIDI pedals just work when plugged in). "Teach KGuitar your 4 buttons" asks you to press A, B, C and D in turn: start/stop, back to the start, loop this bar, Hear it. If the Pocket Master shows up in the MIDI list, untick Listen for it.

Sound

Hear it, tapped notes and the quizzes use real guitar sounds. Pick one in Song player → Options → Sound or in Settings → Sound → Playback sound: Acoustic, Acoustic J-45, Nylon (great for ukulele), Clean electric, Jazz electric, Crunch, Distorted or a simple synth. The amp sounds were made from your own Peavey 5150 amp captures and cab impulse responses. Jam has its own Guitar sound choice.

Vibrate on taps

Pads, keys, the tuner when a string is in tune, quiz answers, tap tempo and the rhythm trainer give a small buzz under your finger. It never buzzes while the mic is recording. Switch it off in Settings → Sound → Vibrate on taps.

The look (Psychedelic)

In the phone app the Psychedelic background stays still (easier on the battery and the eyes). On the web version it drifts slowly; Settings → Look → Moving colours turns that off.

8. The menu and the poster

Small things that make the screen yours.

Why: A screen set up your way keeps you playing instead of hunting for buttons.
When: Whenever something is in the way: hide the menu, move windows, pick your look.

Full screen

In the phone app, Settings → Look → Full screen hides the phone's own buttons, status bar and the Samsung taskbar, so nothing covers the bottom of the app. Swipe up from the bottom middle and they come back for a few seconds, then tuck away again. Without it, the app keeps its buttons clear of them by itself.

Tabs across the top, folds and the i buttons

Songs, Learn, Jam, Tools and Settings split into a few pages with a row of tabs across the top. Inside a page, extra parts fold into one line each (Looper, Famous progressions, Build your own practice tab …): tap the line to open or close it, and the app remembers. A small i next to a heading shows what it does.

Pinch to zoom

Anything small can be made bigger with two fingers: the tab, every fretboard (quizzes, Scales, Scales & chords), chord shapes, the hand shape, the circle of fifths, the practice calendar and the Jam chord cards. Drag with one finger to look around; the 1× button puts it back. Each place remembers its size. The tab in the song player also has − and + in its corner (the same as Options → Size), and its lines always run the full width of the box: the bars on each line stretch to fill it, so there is no gap on the right before the next line. Game Mode zooms the same way (pinch, or − and +).

Hide the menu

Tap « Hide at the bottom of the side menu (or ⌄ on the bottom bar), or swipe it away. A small tab stays on the left edge: tap it to slide the menu out, pick a section, and it tucks away again. Keep open puts it back for good.

The KGuitar poster

The little picture in the menu (and on Learn on phones) is the KGuitar poster: tap it to see it full screen, tap again to zoom in and drag around. Settings → Look can hide it.

9. Keeping your progress

Everything is stored on your phone or tablet.

Why: Your progress is your history: streaks, songs, recordings and settings. A backup means a new phone or a reset never loses it.

When: Once a week (the app reminds you), and always before changing phones.

Back up

Settings → Backup → Back up now, then pick Google Drive in the share menu. Restore from that file on a new phone or tablet to bring back your songs, streak and progress.

Reminders

Settings → You → Reminders sends a daily reminder at the time you choose, plus an optional late "streak saver". Days you've already practised are skipped.

What you use

Settings → You → What you use. KGuitar counts which screens, pages and buttons you open, on this phone only (nothing is sent anywhere). It shows your favourites, and after a month the things you haven't opened, so the app can be trimmed to how you really use it. "Start counting again" clears it.

Day, Night and Psychedelic

Settings → Look. Psychedelic is the default: neon colours on deep purple with liquid colour drifting behind everything, and the KGuitar artwork all through the app: Brandy the chocolate lab and the other samurai dogs (every one with a guitar), dragon guitars, amp towers, oni suns and moons, mushrooms and waves. Each screen has its own picture at the top, and snippets of the art float behind the cards. The words always sit on dark cards so they stay easy to read. Your samurai picks the dog who greets you on finished songs, quizzes, celebrations and empty pages (or Mix it up for a different one each day). The art shows every picture: tap one to see it full screen, tap again to zoom, and use the arrows to step through them. The background holds still while KGuitar is listening to you, and Moving colours switches the motion off altogether (it also stops if the phone is set to reduce motion). Day is bright and clear; Night is dim and low-glare for practising in bed; "Match my phone" switches between them with your phone's dark mode.

10. Tips for getting good

What actually makes you better, fastest.

Why: Knowing how to practise matters as much as what you practise.
When: Read them once, then come back whenever progress feels slow.

Little and often

15 minutes every day beats 2 hours once a week. The streak and reminders are there to help with exactly that.

Slow and clean first

Play it right slowly, then speed up a little at a time. Use the speed trainer on the hard bars.

Loop the hard part

Don't replay the whole song to fix one bar. Loop just those bars until they're green.

Use your ears

Hum what you play, do a round of ear training most days, and play songs you love.